> everything. I am not speaking for Fidel Castro, but I think that he and the Government of Cuba, evidently, would declare demobilization and would appeal to the people to get down to peaceful labor. Then, too, the question of armaments would disappear, since, if there is no threat, then armaments are a burden for every people. Then, too, the question of the destruction, not only of armaments which you recall offensive, but of all other armaments as well would look different.

Khrushchev warned that if people did not show wisdom, 'then, in the final analysis, they will come to a clash, like blind moles and then reciprocal extermination will begin'. He suggested he and Kennedy needed to show 'statesmanlike wisdom':

> I propose: we, for our part, will declare that our ships, bound for Cuba, will not carry any kind of armaments. You would declare that the United States will not invade Cuba with its forces and will not support any sort of forces which might intend to carry out an invasion of Cuba. Then the necessity for the presence of our military specialists in Cuba would disappear.[42]

There was no mention of a UN role in verifying withdrawal of the missiles. There was reference to 'military specialists' rather than missiles. Khrushchev made clear he could not speak for Castro. Of particular note was that there was nothing about missiles in Turkey (nor had there been in the discussion with U Thant or between Scali and Feklisov). When a more formal (and public) letter was sent on the Saturday morning, however, the Turkish Jupiters made their presence felt.

Twelve pages of fluff or not, Khrushchev's letter chimed with the messages from U Thant and John Scali. So, when members of ExComm went to bed on Friday, 26 October, there was cautious optimism about a diplomatic settlement. That optimism quickly evaporated the following morning. Saturday, 27 October 1962 became known in Washington, and to students of the crisis, as 'Black Saturday.' Robert McNamara later recounted, 'as I left the White House and walked through the garden to my